Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-19

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 28:1-10

1 Now David assembled at Jerusalem all the leaders of Israel: the officers of the tribes and the captains of the divisions who served the king, the captains over thousands and captains over hundreds, and the stewards over all the substance and possessions of the king and of his sons, with the officials, the valiant men, and all the mighty men of valor.

2 Then King David rose to his feet and said, "Hear me, my brethren and my people: I had it in my heart to build a house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and for the footstool of our God, and had made preparations to build it.

3 But God said to me, 'You shall not build a house for My name, because you have been a man of war and have shed blood.'

4 However the Lord God of Israel chose me above all the house of my father to be king over Israel forever, for He has chosen Judah to be the ruler. And of the house of Judah, the house of my father, and among the sons of my father, He was pleased with me to make me king over all Israel.

5 And of all my sons (for the Lord has given me many sons) He has chosen my son Solomon to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the Lord over Israel.

6 Now He said to me, 'It is your son Solomon who shall build My house and My courts; for I have chosen him to be My son, and I will be his Father.

7 Moreover I will establish his kingdom forever, if he is steadfast to observe My commandments and My judgments, as it is this day.'

8 Now therefore, in the sight of all Israel, the assembly of the Lord, and in the hearing of our God, be careful to seek out all the commandments of the Lord your God, that you may possess this good land, and leave it as an inheritance for your children after you forever.

9 "As for you, my son Solomon, know the God of your father, and serve Him with a loyal heart and with a willing mind; for the Lord searches all hearts and understands all the

intent of the thoughts. If you seek Him, He will be found by you; but if you forsake Him, He will cast you off forever.

10 Consider now, for the Lord has chosen you to build a house for the sanctuary; be strong, and do it."

II. Key Summary

• David gathered the leaders of the tribes, the captains, the stewards over the king's possessions, and the mighty men of valor at Jerusalem, then rose to his feet to speak to them (vv. 1–2).

• David said he had it in his heart to build a house for the ark and had made preparations, but God told him he must not build it because he was a man of war and had shed blood. Of all David's sons, the Lord chose Solomon to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the Lord and to build His house and courts (vv. 2–6).

• David told the people to seek out and keep all the commandments of the Lord, and told Solomon to know God and serve Him with a loyal heart and a willing mind, ending with "be strong, and do it" (vv. 8–10).

III. Passage Analysis

God Chose Who Would Build

> "In David's declaration, what is emphasized most is God's 'choosing' (vv. 4, 5, 6, 10): God chose the tribe of Judah out of Israel, chose David's father's house out of the tribe of Judah, chose David out of his father's house, and finally chose Solomon out of David's sons to be king (v. 5), to build the temple, and to be God's adopted son (v. 6)." [1]

In verse 2 David says, "I had it in my heart to build," and in verse 3 God says, "You shall not." Then in verses 4–6, everything David talks about is the Lord's choosing: He chose Judah, He chose David's father's house, and He chose Solomon to build His house.

Who would be king and who would build the temple both came from God's choice.

Know God First, Then Serve Him

> "We notice that the command to know came before the command to serve. 'To know God is to serve Him. All failure in service is the result of loss of vision of God, misapprehension of Him, due to some distance from Him.'" [2]

In verse 9, David's first instruction to Solomon is "know the God of your father," and only after that "serve Him with a loyal heart and with a willing mind," followed by a promise: "If you seek Him, He will be found by you."

Knowing God comes before serving Him.

IV. Reflection Question

If you were chosen to be in charge of a really important job, what would you do first?

Solomon was chosen by the Lord to build the temple (v. 10). The choosing came from God first, so Solomon did not have to carry the weight of building the temple alone, just as New Testament believers are saved by God's free grace [1]; and the first thing David handed him was "know the God of your father," because "if you seek Him, He will be found by you" (v. 9).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 1 Chronicles 28 Notes (《歷代志上聖經綜合解讀》), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT28.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik (quoting G. Campbell Morgan), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-28/